Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

Thursday 11 June 2026
Morning (Time: 1 hour 30 minutes)

PAPER REFERENCE
1HI0/33

History

Paper 3: Modern depth study

Option 33: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75

Sources/Interpretations Booklet

Do not return this Booklet with the question paper.

Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.
This booklet contains Source B, Source C, Interpretation 1 and Interpretation 2 for use with Question 3 on the question paper.

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Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.

Sources for use with Questions 3(a) and 3(c).

Source B

Source B: From a letter written by Martin Luther King Jr. while imprisoned in Birmingham Jail, April 1963.
We did not create this tension in Birmingham; we merely brought to the surface a tension that was already alive. For years, our people have been told to 'Wait!' But this 'Wait' has almost always meant 'Never.' Non-violent direct action seeks to create such a crisis and establish such a creative tension that a community which has constantly refused to negotiate is forced to confront the issue.

Source C

Source C: From a statement by Albert Boutwell, the newly elected moderate Mayor of Birmingham, published in a local newspaper, May 1963.
These outside agitators have come to Birmingham just as we were starting to make progress on our own. Their demonstrations are ill-timed and have caused unnecessary chaos, hurting our local merchants. The integration of our department stores and lunch counters cannot be forced overnight by street mobs. We need calm discussion between local leaders, not racial confrontation.

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Interpretations for use with Section B.

Interpretations for use with Questions 3(b), 3(c) and 3(d).

Interpretation 1

Interpretation 1: From a modern historical study.
The Birmingham campaign was a brilliant tactical victory that transformed the civil rights movement. By deliberately provoking Connor's brutal response, King created shocking television footage that horrified the global public. This media coverage put immense moral pressure on President Kennedy, forcing his administration to abandon its cautious approach and draft the landmark civil rights legislation that became the Civil Rights Act of 1964.

Interpretation 2

Interpretation 2: From a different historical perspective.
While Birmingham was a public relations success, its immediate achievements on the ground were highly limited. The local agreement signed to end the marches did very little to desegregate the city or improve the lives of poor Black residents, who still faced poverty and discrimination. Indeed, the campaign triggered a violent white backlash, including the bombing of the Sixteenth Street Baptist Church, which showed that segregationists remained undefeated.

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